

MIZORAM PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION
COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION FOR RESEARCH INVESTIGATOR
UNDER ART & CULTURE DEPARTMENT,
GOVERNMENT OF MIZORAM.
(MAY-2026)
PAPER-I

Time Allowed : 3 hours

FM : 100

PART - A (Conventional Type) (40 Marks)

*This section should be answered only on the Answer Sheet provided.
Marks for each question is indicated against it.*

1. Write an essay choosing one of the topics below: (10)
 - (a) Research and Documentation in Culture
 - (b) Smart Cities and Environmental Sustainability
 - (c) Measures to preserve and promote Mizo cultural practices in this day and age
2. Write a precis of the following passage by reducing it to one third of its length. (10)

Trees give shade for the benefit of others, while they themselves stand in the sun and endure the scorching heat. They produce fruit by which others profit. The character of a good man is like that of trees. What is the use of this perishable body if it is not used for the benefit of mankind? The more sandalwood is rubbed, the more scent it gives. The more sugar cane is peeled and cut into pieces, the more juice it produces. The more gold is burnt, the more brightly it shines. Noble people do not lose their qualities even by losing their lives. What does it matter whether man praises them or not? What difference does it make whether riches abide with them or not? What does it matter whether they die at this moment or their lives are prolonged? Come what may, those who tread on the right path will not set foot on any other. Life itself is unprofitable to a man who does not live for others. To live for the sake of living one's life is to live a worthless life.
3. Write a letter to the Station Master complaining about the unclean condition of platforms at your local railway station. Suggest measures to improve cleanliness. Sign as ABC. (10)

Direction (Question Nos. 4 - 8): Read the following passage and answer the questions based on the given passage:

In recent years, the rapid advancement of technology has transformed the way people communicate, work, and access information. While these changes have brought undeniable benefits—such as increased efficiency and global connectivity—they have also introduced new challenges. One such challenge is the growing dependence on digital devices, which has raised concerns about reduced attention spans and diminished face-to-face interactions.

Moreover, the rise of automation and artificial intelligence has sparked debates about the future of employment. Many experts argue that while certain jobs will become obsolete, new opportunities will emerge that require different skill sets. This shift emphasizes the importance of adaptability and continuous learning in the modern workforce.

Another significant issue is data privacy. As individuals share more personal information online, the risk of data breaches and misuse has increased. Governments and organizations are now under pressure to implement stricter regulations and improve cybersecurity measures to protect users.

Despite these concerns, it is important to recognize that technology itself is not inherently harmful. Its impact largely depends on how it is used. By promoting responsible usage and maintaining a balance between digital and real-world interactions, society can harness the benefits of technology while minimizing its drawbacks.

4. What are the two main benefits of technology mentioned in the passage? (2)
5. What does the passage suggest about automation and employment? (2)
6. What balance does the author suggest individuals should maintain? (2)
7. What is meant by “continuous learning” in the context of the passage? (2)
8. Why has the risk of data misuse increased in recent years? (2)

PART - B (Multiple Choice Questions) (60 Marks)

All questions carry equal mark of 1.

*This section should be answered only on the **OMR Response Sheet** provided.*

Notes regarding Negative Marking :

- (i) *There will be penalty (negative marking) for every wrong answer given by a candidate in the MCQ type questions.*
 - (ii) *For each question for which a wrong answer has been given by the candidate, one-third of the marks assigned to that question will be deducted as penalty.*
 - (iii) *If a candidate gives more than one answer to one question, it will be treated as wrong answer even if one of the given answers happens to be correct and there will be same penalty as above for that question.*
 - (iv) *If any questions is left blank i.e. no answer is given by the candidate, there will be no penalty for that question.*
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Direction (Question Nos. 1 - 20): Choose the correct Parts of Speech from the bolded words in the given sentences:

1. India is a **country** with diverse cultures and languages.
 - (a) Adjective of Quality
 - (b) Proper Noun
 - (c) Adjective of Quantity
 - (d) Common Noun
2. **Honesty** is the best policy.
 - (a) Common Noun
 - (b) Proper Noun
 - (c) Abstract Noun
 - (d) Collective Noun
3. Mizoram is a **beautiful** state.
 - (a) Adjective of Quality
 - (b) Adjective of Quantity
 - (c) Adjective of Number
 - (d) Demonstrative Adjective
4. Do not be **such** a coward.
 - (a) Adjective of Quality
 - (b) Adjective of Quantity
 - (c) Adjective of Number
 - (d) Demonstrative Adjective
5. Sanga is well mannered because **he** has a good upbringing.
 - (a) Personal Pronoun
 - (b) Demonstrative Pronoun
 - (c) Relative Pronoun
 - (d) Emphatic Pronoun
6. I hurt **myself** during the match.
 - (a) Personal Pronoun
 - (b) Demonstrative Pronoun
 - (c) Relative Pronoun
 - (d) Reflexive Pronoun
7. Oranges from Mizoram are sweeter than **those** from the plains.
 - (a) Personal Pronoun
 - (b) Demonstrative Pronoun
 - (c) Relative Pronoun
 - (d) Reflexive Pronoun
8. The milkman delivers milk **daily**.
 - (a) Adverb of Place
 - (b) Adverb of Time
 - (c) Adverb of Manner
 - (d) Adverb of Degree
9. They are **fully** prepared for the conference.
 - (a) Adverb of Place
 - (b) Adverb of Time
 - (c) Adverb of Manner
 - (d) Adverb of Degree

10. Our home is humble, **but** it is filled with love.
(a) Pronoun (b) Adjective
(c) Conjunction (d) Adverb
11. The teacher praised the **brilliant** student.
(a) Adjective (b) Adverb
(c) Noun (d) Conjunction
12. The **book** is on the table.
(a) Adverb (b) Conjunction
(c) Noun (d) Adjective
13. They went to the market **after** lunch.
(a) Noun (b) Preposition
(c) Conjunction (d) Adverb
14. I like tea **and** coffee.
(a) Noun (b) Adjective
(c) Interjection (d) Conjunction
15. He is a **very** intelligent boy.
(a) Verb (b) Pronoun
(c) Preposition (d) Adverb
16. Please **sit** here.
(a) Verb (b) Noun
(c) Adjective (d) Adverb
17. I have **two** books.
(a) Noun (b) Verb
(c) Adjective (d) Pronoun
18. **Oh!** That hurts.
(a) Preposition (b) Interjection
(c) Verb (d) Adjective
19. The **old** man walked slowly.
(a) Conjunction (b) Noun
(c) Adverb (d) Adjective
20. The birds are flying **above** the trees.
(a) Preposition (b) Noun
(c) Verb (d) Conjunction

Direction (Question Nos. 21 - 25): Choose the correct synonyms for the following words:

21. courteous
(a) regal (b) orderly
(c) official (d) polite
22. despise
(a) disdain (b) disagree
(c) respect (d) wise
23. foe
(a) duo (b) enemy
(c) noble (d) rage

24. meticulous
(a) strict (b) careful
(c) blissful (d) careless
25. agony
(a) pain (b) chance
(c) desire (d) compel

Direction (Question Nos. 26 - 35): Choose the correct words for the given sentences:

26. A thing that remains fixed.
(a) mobile (b) stationery
(c) stationary (d) mettle
27. Lacking in experience or informed judgement.
(a) dewy eyed (b) seasoned
(c) vain (d) sceptical
28. Known for bad things
(a) incredible (b) gullible
(c) expatriate (d) notorious
29. Likely to attract attention
(a) sombre (b) conspicuous
(c) ostracize (d) mortify
30. To express scornfully one's low opinion
(a) tumultuous (b) denigrate
(c) ferocious (d) proclaim
31. Fluent and clear in speech.
(a) Emotional (b) Enthusiastic
(c) Verbatim (d) Articulate
32. An inscription on a tomb.
(a) Epitaph (b) Epilogue
(c) Elegy (d) Eulogy
33. Opinion contrary to accepted doctrines.
(a) Controversy (b) Convention
(c) Advocacy (d) Heresy
34. Governed by a sense of duty.
(a) Conscious (b) Conscientious
(c) Intelligent (d) Sensible
35. A written declaration made on oath in the presence of a magistrate.
(a) Document (b) Affidavit
(c) Dossier (d) Voucher

Direction (Question Nos. 36 - 45): Choose the correct Indirect Speech of the given sentences:

36. Sanga says, "Mawia is very intelligent."
(a) Sanga says that Mawia was very intelligent.
(b) Sanga said that Mawia is very intelligent.
(c) Sanga expressed that Mawia is very intelligent.
(d) Sanga says that Mawia is very intelligent.
37. The teacher said, "The students are crying."
(a) The teacher said that the students were crying.
(b) The teacher has said that the students are crying.
(c) The teacher says that the students were crying.
(d) The teacher said that the students are crying.
38. Sarah said, "Jonathan will play basketball."
(a) Sarah said that Jonathan will be playing basketball.
(b) Sarah said that Jonathan would play basketball.
(c) Sarah said that Jonathan will play basketball.
(d) Sarah said that Jonathan would have played basketball.
39. She said, "I will cook dinner in the evening."
(a) She said that she would cook dinner in the evening.
(b) She said that she will cook dinner in the evening.
(c) She said that she will be cooking dinner in the evening.
(d) She said that she shall cook dinner in the evening.
40. He said to me, "I do not like your new purchase."
(a) He told me that he does not like my new purchase.
(b) He told me that he did not like my new purchase.
(c) He told me that he is disliking my new purchase.
(d) He told me that he will not like my new purchase.
41. "I am going to the school tomorrow," she said.
(a) She said that she was going to the school the next day.
(b) She said she will go to school the next day.
(c) She said I will go to school tomorrow.
(d) She said that I was going to the school the next day.
42. "Where do you live?", he asked.
(a) He asked where I live.
(b) He asked where I lived.
(c) He asked where do you live.
(d) He asked where was I living.
43. "Please sit down," she said.
(a) She told them to sit down, please.
(b) She asked them to sit.
(c) She requested them to sit down.
(d) She says please, sit down.

44. They said, "we will arrive tomorrow".
(a) They said we will arrive the next day.
(b) They said we will come tomorrow.
(c) They said that they would arrive the next day.
(d) They said that they will arrive the next day.
45. "Please close the door", she said.
(a) She requested to close the door.
(b) She said close the door.
(c) She please asked to close the door.
(d) Close the door she requested.

Direction (Question Nos. 46 - 50): Choose the correct tense of the following sentences:

46. He **was singing** a beautiful song.
(a) Past Indefinite Tense (b) Past Continuous Tense
(c) Past Perfect Tense (d) Present Continuous Tense
47. She **has been attending** classes all year round.
(a) Present Continuous Tense (b) Past Continuous Tense
(c) Present Perfect Continuous Tense (d) Present Perfect Tense
48. I **shall have been waiting** for the next bus.
(a) Future Continuous Tense (b) Past Perfect Continuous Tense
(c) Future Perfect Continuous Tense (d) Present Perfect Tense
49. She **went** to the hospital.
(a) Present Indefinite Tense (b) Past Indefinite Tense
(c) Past Perfect Tense (d) Past Continuous Tense
50. You **will have had** your lunch.
(a) Future Perfect Tense (b) Past Indefinite Tense
(c) Past Perfect Tense (d) Past Continuous Tense

Direction (Question No 51 – 60): Select the word that best completes the sentence:

51. If I _____ rich, I would travel the world.
(a) am (b) was
(c) were (d) be
52. The Committee _____ divided in its opinion.
(a) are (b) is
(c) were (d) have
53. She is one of those writers who _____ always inspired me.
(a) has (b) have
(c) is (d) was
54. Each of the players _____ performed well.
(a) have (b) had
(c) are (d) has
55. This book is _____ interesting than I expected.
(a) very (b) far more
(c) too (d) quite

56. His arguments were so _____ that even experts found them difficult to understand.
(a) lucid (b) obscure
(c) coherent (d) rational
57. The author's writing style is known for its _____ descriptions and vivid imagery.
(a) evocative (b) bland
(c) dull (d) rigid
58. The system is designed to _____ errors before they occur.
(a) amplify (b) ignore
(c) escalate (d) mitigate
59. The manager took a _____ approach to employee complaints, addressing them immediately.
(a) indifferent (b) dismissive
(c) proactive (d) passive
60. The results were so _____ that they required further verification.
(a) reliable (b) definite
(c) conclusive (d) inconclusive

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